

The First Client Playbook

What to sell, who to target, and exactly how to land your first local business client. A free field manual for starting a one-person agency with one simple service local businesses already understand.

YOU'RE BUILDING

A One-Person Agency

WHAT YOU SELL

Review Automation

FIRST WIN

Google Reviews

The whole path to your first client is already written down.

Most people trying to get their first client freeze on the same two questions: who do I go after, and what do I even say? This playbook removes both. You'll choose a niche from a proven list, the cities are mapped, the messages are written. Your job is to follow the path.

And here's what you're really doing, even if it doesn't feel like it on day one. You're not just chasing a random client. You're building the first block of a one-person agency: a real business with no team, no employees, no office, just you, a laptop, and one simple service that local businesses already know they need. The first client is the proof that the whole thing works.

First, a decision that takes five minutes

Before anything else, you pick one niche. There's a list of thirty in Phase 11, each one chosen because it's a quietly perfect place to start: local, phone-driven businesses where reviews decide who wins, and where almost no agency is bothering to compete. Garage door repair. Septic pumping. Tree services. The unglamorous ones nobody else wants, which is exactly why they're open.

HOW TO READ THIS PLAYBOOK

Everything that follows uses appliance repair as the running example. Every message, every audit, every number is shown through that one niche so the path stays concrete and easy to follow.

But appliance repair is just the example. **You'll pick your own niche from the list in Phase 11**, and then swap it in everywhere. Wherever you read "appliance repair," you read your niche. Wherever a message says "the dryer's still making that noise," you write the equivalent for your own niche. The system is identical. Only the words change.

What you'll sell, and why it's the easy first yes.

The one service at the center of this whole playbook is review automation: helping a local business collect more Google reviews, automatically. It's the starter offer for one reason. It's the easiest thing you will ever sell.

The thirty niches share a shape, and that shape is what makes review automation an easy first sale in any of them. They're phone-first and emergency-driven, so a broken fridge or a dead water heater is an urgent problem, and the customer calls whoever looks the most trustworthy. On Google, "most trustworthy" almost always means "most reviews." That makes reviews the fastest yes you'll ever sell, because the owner already knows they need them. They just don't have a system.

And these owners tend to be brilliant at the actual work and almost entirely absent online. That gap, great service and thin digital presence, is the opening you walk through.

THE WHOLE IDEA IN ONE LINE

You're not pouring more water into their bucket. You're finding the holes, missing reviews and missed calls, and offering to plug them. Reviews are the first plug, and the easiest sale.

HOW TO USE THIS

Work it top to bottom. Don't read the whole thing twice before starting. That's preparation dressed up as fear. Pick your niche, pick a town from the back, run the test, audit three businesses, send three messages. You learn this by doing it, not by studying it.

The path, in order

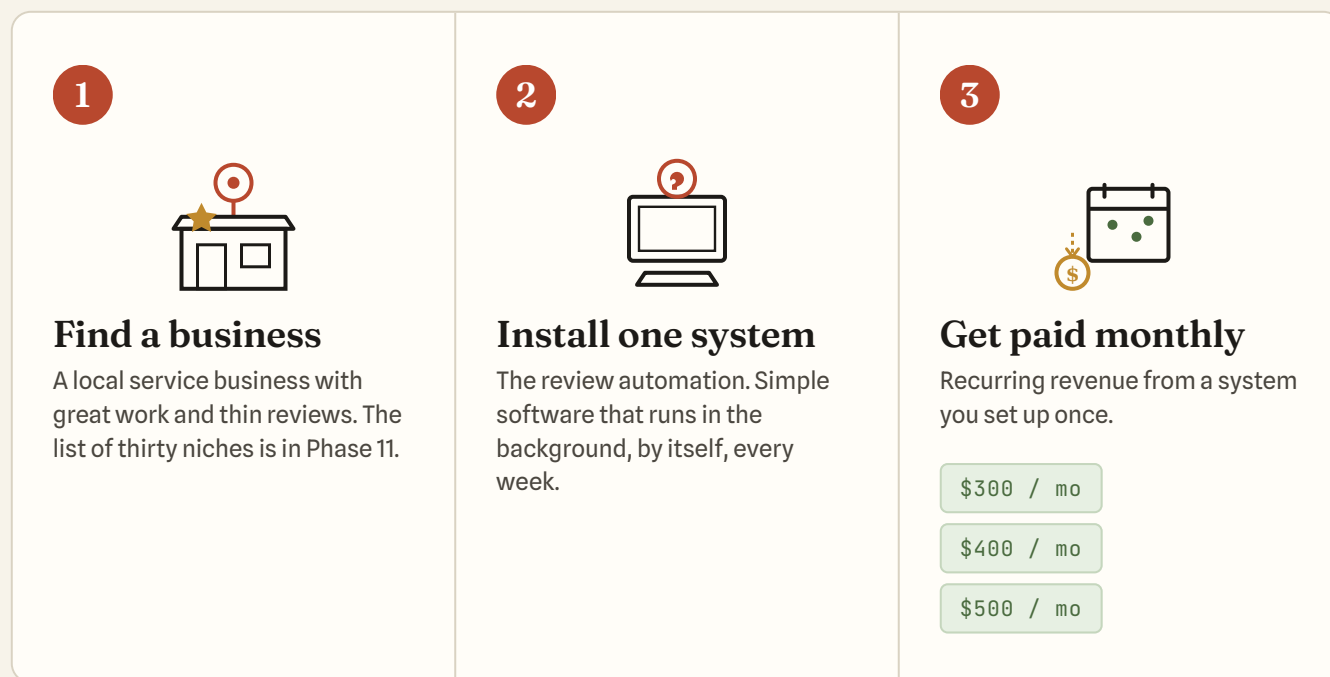
01	Choose Your Niche	The thirty-niche list and how to pick one
02	Find the Right Town	The review-gap test that tells you where to work
03	Audit the Prospect	Sixty seconds to find the one gap worth leading with
04	Reach Out	The exact messages and the five-day follow-up
05	What You Sell	The Review Revenue System, the price, what comes next
06	Inside the Review Revenue System	How the automation actually works, piece by piece
07	Handle the Objections	The questions every owner asks, and what to say
08	Build Your Agency Site	A ready-to-paste prompt for your own web presence
09	Your First 30 Days	A day-by-day plan from zero to first client
10	Setting It Up in HighLevel	The click-path that gets the system running
11	The Niche & City Lists	Thirty niches and two hundred towns to begin

HOW TO USE THIS

Work it top to bottom. Don't read the whole thing twice before starting. That's preparation dressed up as fear. Pick your niche, pick a town from the back, run the test, audit three businesses, send three messages. You learn this by doing it, not by studying it.

Find. Install. Collect.

Before we walk the path one phase at a time, here's the entire business on a single page. Everything that follows is just the detailed version of these three steps.



One business. One system. Paid every month.

PHASE 01

Choose your niche

Before you find a town or send a message, you pick one niche and commit to it. One niche, worked deeply, beats five worked halfway.

PICK ONE • DON'T MIX AND MATCH

One niche. Picked on purpose.

The single fastest way to stall is to stay a generalist who helps "local businesses." You want to be the person who helps garage door companies, or septic pumpers, or tree services. Specific is easier to sell, easier to refer, and easier to get good at.

Why one niche beats many

When you pick one niche, three things get easier at once. Your outreach message gets sharper, because you know exactly what this kind of owner struggles with. Your delivery gets faster, because every client needs the same setup. And your reputation compounds, because the third garage-door client is far easier to land once you can say you already work with two others just like them.

Mixing niches does the opposite. Every message starts from scratch, every setup feels custom, and you never build the momentum of being known for one thing.

THE FILTER

A good starter niche is local, phone-first, and emergency-or-urgency driven, where one job is worth real money and reviews visibly decide who gets the call. The thirty niches in Phase 11 all pass this test. Pick whichever you have some connection to, or simply whichever you find least boring.

A word on "boring"

Nobody dreams of running a grease-trap-cleaning marketing agency. That's the point. The boring niches are wide open precisely because they're boring. The owners are out on the job missing calls, and almost no agency is competing for them. Boring is where the money is least defended.

And remember what you're building here. Not a sprawling agency with a team and an office, just a one-person operation where you pick a lane, get good at one simple service, and own it. The narrower the niche, the easier that is.

FOR THE REST OF THIS PLAYBOOK

We'll use **appliance repair** as our example from here on. Pick yours now, before you turn the page, and read every example as if it said your niche instead. The 30-niche list is in Phase 11 if you want to choose before continuing.

PHASE 02

Find the right town

Not every city is worth your time. You're hunting for one specific shape in the search results, and once you can see it, you can't unsee it.

THE REVIEW-GAP TEST

The gap is your whole sales argument.

Before you audit a single business, look at the whole search and check for a gap between the leaders and everyone else. That gap is your entire pitch, built right into the town.

Open Google Maps and search appliance repair [city][state]. (Your niche, your city.) Now read the review counts down the page.

WHAT A PERFECT TOWN LOOKS LIKE

Top shop · 214 reviews

2nd place · 146

3rd place · 81

↓ **the long tail (your prospects)** · 17 · 11 · 5

The top tier proves reviews win the market. The tail is who you sell to, and they can see exactly who's beating them.

Why the gap matters

A shop with eleven reviews sitting under three shops with two hundred is the easiest conversation you'll ever have. You don't have to convince them reviews matter. The proof is right there on the same screen, in the form of the competitor taking their calls.

WORK THIS TOWN

- ✓ Top few shops have strong counts, often in the hundreds
- ✓ A long tail underneath sitting at 5 to 20 reviews
- ✓ A clear, visible gap between the two

SKIP THIS TOWN

- ✗ Everyone already has hundreds. Market's saturated
- ✗ Even the top shops only have a handful. Reviews aren't deciding the market yet
- ✗ No real spread between first place and last

The starter city list in Phase 11 gives you two hundred towns to begin with. But the map is the real filter. Trust what you see in the search results over any number on a list.

PHASE 03

Audit the prospect

One minute per business. You're not writing a report. You're finding the single gap you'll lead with in your first message.

FIND THE GAP, THEN REACH OUT

Walk in knowing the one thing.

Once you've got a town with the right shape, pick businesses from the tail and run each through a quick audit. You're not building a case file. You're finding the one thing worth mentioning in your first message. Find the gap first, then reach out.

Open the listing and look for three things, in order. First, the review count against the competitors right above them. That's almost always your lead. Second, whether the recent reviews dried up. Third, whether there's even a website linked. You can spot all three in about fifteen seconds once you've done it a few times.

RECENCY COUNTS AS MUCH AS THE NUMBER

A shop with forty reviews from the last few months is in better shape than one with two hundred that stopped two years ago. Google rewards recency. If the recent reviews dried up, that's part of your angle too.

The audit, one per business

A • THE REVIEW GAP (YOUR PRIMARY ANGLE)

This shop's review count vs. the top competitor's count. How recent is their last review?

B • LISTING COMPLETENESS

Photos present? Description filled in? Hours listed? Owner replies to reviews? Website linked?

C • WEBSITE STATUS

No website? Dated or poor on mobile? No clear way to call or book? Or solid, no issue?

D • YOUR ONE LEAD-IN

Big review gap, stale reviews, or no/dated website. Pick one. That's the line you'll open with.

SAVED FOR LATER

Most of these niches are phone-first, and the owners miss calls while they're under a machine or up a ladder. That's a real problem worth solving, but it's the **second** conversation, not the first. Lead with reviews. Offer call coverage once you've delivered.

PHASE 04

Reach out

Short, specific, and built around the gap you just found. Then follow up, because that's where most of the money actually is.

THE MESSAGES, WORD FOR WORD

You don't write it. You send it.

Most outreach fails because it leads with the sender. Yours leads with their business. You've done thirty seconds of homework, you mention one specific thing, and you make the ask tiny: a yes-or-no question, not a request to block out half an hour. That alone puts you ahead of almost everyone else in their inbox.

MESSAGE 1 • THE OPENER (EMAIL OR DM)

Hey **[name]**, I was looking at **[business]** and noticed you've got some genuinely great reviews. Nice work. The thing is, **[top competitor]** is showing up above you mostly because they've got more of them. I put together a quick, simple way to close that gap that's been getting my clients fifteen-plus new five-star reviews a week. Want me to send it over? Takes about thirty seconds to look at.

Why it works: "I was looking at [business]" proves it isn't a mass blast. Naming the competitor creates quiet urgency. Nobody likes being out-ranked. And the ask is a tiny yes-or-no, so saying yes is the path of least resistance.

The follow-up is where the money is

Most replies don't come on the first message. They come on the second or third. So the follow-up isn't optional. It's the job. Three messages across five days. Don't re-pitch. Just resurface.

MESSAGE 2 • THE SOFT BUMP (+24 HOURS)

Hey **[name]**, salespeople are the worst, so I get it if you'd like me to stop bugging you. That said, I'd hate for you to miss out on closing the review gap on **[competitor]** just because I didn't send one more note. Alright if I send the video over?

MESSAGE 3 • THE EASY OUT (+3 DAYS)

Sometimes it's just not meant to be, **[name]**, and I get it. Before I close your file, I wanted to follow up one last time to make sure you're absolutely, positively not interested. If you are, drop me a line. If I don't hear back, I'll leave you to it and keep up the great work.

THE FOLLOW-UP RULE

Giving them an easy way out signals you're not desperate, which is often exactly what gets the reply. The follow-up isn't persuasion. It's just visibility. Inside HighLevel, all three of these send automatically once you add the prospect.

If the gap opener isn't landing.

Lead with the gap opener. It's the workhorse. But if a batch goes quiet, here are two variations worth testing. Same idea, different doorway in.

The free-gift opener

Instead of pointing at the gap, you offer something free and tangible up front. It costs you nothing to send and it's hard to say no to, because you're giving, not asking.

THE FREE-GIFT OPENER (EMAIL OR DM)

Hey [name], I was just looking through your Google profile and saw you're getting some really good reviews. Can I share the review request script that's been getting my clients fifteen-plus new Google reviews a week? Free to use, no strings. Want me to send it over?

Why it works: a free, specific, valuable thing is a different psychology than a problem. The gap opener says "here's what's wrong." This one says "here's a gift." Some owners respond to one, some to the other, so it's worth having both.

The DM version

On Instagram or Facebook, drop the formality. No signature, no paragraphs. Short reads as human; long reads as a pitch.

THE DM (INSTAGRAM / FACEBOOK)

Hey [name], [your name] here. Was just checking out your page, you've got some great reviews by the way. I spotted something that could help you get a lot more of them and recorded a quick video on it. Want me to send it over?

Why it works: same gap idea, stripped to three lines and a yes-or-no. The "recorded a quick video" line gives them something concrete to say yes to, and it's an easy next step for you to deliver.

PHASE 05

What you sell

One service to start. The Review Revenue System. Deliver it, earn trust, then offer the next rung. Not before.

THE OFFER & THE PRICE

The Review Revenue System.

When they say "send it over," you're not selling them everything at once. You lead with the one thing they already know they need: more Google reviews, on a system that runs itself. That system has a name, the Review Revenue System, and it does three things in the background.

1 Capture

Every customer's details are collected automatically after the job is done.

2 Request

A timed, personal review request goes out by text and email while the great service is still fresh in their mind.

3 Follow-up

Gentle automated reminders go out until the review is left, so no happy customer slips through.

WHY THE OWNER SAYS YES

93%

of consumers read reviews before
choosing a local business

78%

of customers buy from whoever
responds first

Recency

40 fresh reviews beat 200 from two
years ago

None of this is a hard sell. The owner already believes reviews matter. They're watching a competitor outrank them on the same screen. You're not there to convince them of the problem. You're there with the fix, on a system that runs without them.

The price, and the one rule.

Simple, round, easy to say out loud. And one line you never cross, no matter what.

THE SYSTEM

\$300/mo

Your starting price. Simple, round,
easy to say out loud.

THEIR MATH

1 job

One recovered job a month more than
covers your fee.

YOUR MATH

10 ×

Ten clients on one repeatable system.
No team, no custom work.

As you land clients and your confidence grows, you can raise your rate for new clients. Existing clients stay where they are; the increase only applies to people signing on after the jump. Start simple, prove it, then charge more.

The math runs in the client's favor and yours at the same time. One recovered job covers your whole fee, so the cost is invisible to them. And because it's the same repeatable setup every time, ten clients is the same work as one, just done ten times.

ONE RULE YOU NEVER BREAK

Every customer gets the same review request with a direct Google link. You never filter by star rating, route happy customers to Google and unhappy ones to a private form, or screen reviews before they post. That practice violates Google's terms. The compliant system, same ask, same link, every customer, is the only one you offer, and it's the one that builds a reputation that actually lasts.

PHASE 06

Inside the Review Revenue System

What you're actually selling, piece by piece. Understanding it is what lets you sell it with a straight face.

THE FIVE MECHANISMS

Five small mechanisms, one system.

When the owner asks "so what exactly am I paying for?", this is your answer. The Review Revenue System isn't one thing. It's five small mechanisms working together. You can run them by hand if you want to, but the easy way is to let HighLevel run them for you, where they're already built and just need your client's name dropped in. Either way, you should understand every piece, because understanding it is what lets you sell it with confidence.

01 • The three-message sequence

After every completed job, the customer gets a short sequence. The trick is that the first message isn't even an ask. It's a check-in.

MESSAGE 1 • THE CHECK-IN

Hey Sarah, this is Mike from **[business]**. Just checking in to make sure everything looks good with the work we did today.

No link, no ask. You're just being a good business. Most people reply "looks great, thanks." But if someone says "actually, the dryer's still making that noise," now you know, you fix it, and you've turned a possible bad review into a great one.

MESSAGE 2 • THE REQUEST (GOES TO EVERYONE)

Hi Sarah, Mike here from **[business]**. Thanks again for the chance to help. If you've got 30 seconds, would you mind sharing your experience in a quick Google review? It helps other folks know they can trust us.
[review link]

MESSAGE 3 • THE REMINDER (ONLY IF THEY HAVEN'T CLICKED)

Just a quick follow-up. If you haven't had a chance yet, we'd really appreciate a quick Google review.
[review link]

That third message is the one most people skip, and it's the one that generates the most reviews. The system checks whether they already clicked. If they did, it stops, so nobody gets bugged twice.

DO IT MANUALLY No automation yet? Send a check-in text after each job, wait for the reply, then send the review link. The software just makes it happen every time without anyone remembering.

02 • The reactivation campaign

This is the move that makes owners fall in love with you, and it happens in the very first week. Every business has hundreds of past customers who had a great experience and were simply never asked for a review.

You grab that old customer list from whatever they use, booking software, QuickBooks, a spreadsheet, upload it, and drip review requests out slowly. Two or three every twenty minutes during business hours. Never blast them all at once.

THE MATH THAT WINS THE CASE STUDY

Typically 8 to 15% of past customers leave a review. A shop with 500 past customers gets 40 to 75 new reviews in the first few weeks. For a business sitting at 23 reviews, that's the jump from invisible to competitive, in month one. That first wave becomes the case study that gets you your next client.

03 • Automated review responses

Once reviews start coming in, the system responds to every one automatically. In the reputation settings you turn on AI review response, select Google, and save. Every new review gets a thoughtful, personal reply within minutes, without anyone lifting a finger.

This matters twice over. Google's algorithm favors businesses that respond to reviews. And when a potential customer sees a business replying to every review, it builds real trust. They're far more likely to call that shop over a competitor whose reviews sit there ignored.

DO IT MANUALLY No AI tool? Set aside 20 minutes a week to write responses by hand. The principle is the service: responding to reviews is something businesses need and don't do.

04 • Review repurposing

The icing. Every five-star review automatically becomes a social media post. You connect the client's Facebook, Instagram, and Google profile, pick a schedule, say one post a week, and the system pulls a best review, drops it on a clean branded background with their logo, and posts it.

05 • The reporting that keeps them paying

Now three things run at once: the system requests reviews, responds to them, and turns the best ones into content. The owner watches the count climb on a simple dashboard. That visible progress, week after week, is why they don't cancel. They're not paying for software. They're paying to keep the reviews coming.

WHY THIS IS THE WHOLE BUSINESS

Three mechanisms, running at once, in the background. The owner does nothing and watches their reputation grow. You set it up once and collect every month. That's not a service you have to keep showing up for. It's an asset you installed.

| It never stops working. That's why they pay you every month.

PHASE 07

Handle the objections

You don't need to be a smooth closer. You need to have already thought about the few things every owner says, so the objection becomes the moment they decide to trust you.

WHAT'S BEHIND THEM, AND WHAT TO SAY

The same few questions, every time.

When you have a calm, honest answer ready, the objection stops being a wall and becomes the moment they decide to trust you. Here's what's behind the common ones, and what to say.

Q "If it's that simple, why don't I just do it myself?"

They could, in theory. But after working with enough small businesses, here's the truth: they know they need reviews, they've probably even tried, but they don't have a system. They're not going to build an automation or remember to text after every job. They'd rather pay you to make it happen automatically than spend hours a month doing it themselves. The best long-term clients are usually the ones who already tried and failed on their own.

Q "Will this annoy my customers?"

No, because the first message isn't even an ask, it's a check-in. The requests are spaced out and worded like a person, not a robot. Most customers are glad to help when you make it a ten-second tap. And the reminder only goes to people who haven't already left one, so nobody gets messaged twice.

Q "What if I don't have many customers yet?"

Even a few reviews a month compounds fast, and Google rewards recency. A steady trickle of fresh reviews beats a big pile of old ones. The system makes sure every single job gets its shot at becoming a review, so nothing slips through. Slow and steady still climbs the rankings.

Q "How do I know it's actually working?"

You'll both watch the same dashboard. Review count going up, responses going out, recent reviews stacking. And the honest version of this answer is the strongest: if you don't see new reviews in the first 14 days, you don't pay. That guarantee is easy to make because the system reliably delivers, and offering it removes the last bit of risk on their side.

THE FRAME UNDERNEATH ALL OF IT

You're not selling them something they don't need. Their competitor is already winning calls that should be theirs, just by looking better on Google. You're showing up with the fix to a problem they're already bleeding from. That's not a pitch. It's a favor with a price on it.

And the ones you'll tell yourself.

The owner's objections are easy compared to the ones in your own head. Here are the four that stop most people, and the honest answer to each.

Q "I don't have any experience."

You don't need any. The niche is picked, the messages are written, the system clones in pre-built. The one thing this playbook can't do for you is send the message, and that part doesn't require experience. Your first ten conversations will feel rough. Everyone's do. You build the experience by doing the thing, not before it.

Q "I'm not technical enough."

You're not building software from scratch or learning to code. You're cloning a finished system and changing the business name. The hard parts are already done. And every step has a manual fallback, so even if a menu looks different than you expected, you can still deliver the result by hand while you learn.

Q "What if my niche is different?"

Local businesses may sell different things, but they share the same reputation problem. They need more trust, more reviews, and more consistent follow-up. The system is identical whether you're working with appliance repair or septic pumping. Only the words in the messages change.

Q "I don't have time for this."

The whole point of starting with one simple service is that it doesn't require much time. A few focused hours a week works the plan. You're not building a complicated agency. You're installing one repeatable thing, again and again. The complexity, and the hours, only come if you try to do everything at once. So don't.

| The first client is rarely about the money. It's the proof.

Once you've landed one, the story in your head changes. It stops being "can I do this" and becomes "how many more." That shift is worth more than the first \$300.

Chris.

When he first showed up in my world, he was right at the beginning. No business, no clients, no audience. He'd just been laid off, and was trying to figure out what came next.

He told me later that he almost didn't start. He'd looked at the whole thing and decided he wasn't ready yet. He needed to figure out his niche first. And his offer. And build a website. And a brand. The usual list we tell ourselves we need before we're allowed to begin.

I talked him into starting anyway, before any of that was "ready."

He picked the simplest possible service: helping local businesses get more Google reviews. Not glamorous. Not clever. Just something every local business needs and almost none of them do well. He set up the review automation, built one basic landing page, and reached out to a few businesses he already knew.

His first client paid him \$500 a month to run their review system. The whole thing was automated, so he spent maybe thirty minutes a month on it. By month three, he had four clients. Two thousand dollars a month, recurring, from a service he'd built on a platform he hadn't known existed six months earlier.

Here's the part I want you to sit with. Chris wasn't more talented than you. He wasn't more technical. He didn't have connections or savings or some secret advantage. What he had was a bad month, a simple service, and a willingness to start before he felt ready. That's the entire list.

P.S. Chris told me recently that getting laid off was the best thing that ever happened to him. He makes more now than he did at the corporate job, works fewer hours, and actually likes what he does. Funny how the thing that feels like the bottom is sometimes the start.

PHASE 08

Build your agency site

Look legit before the first reply. A simple site you can build in minutes, not weeks. This is your storefront, not your masterpiece.

A PROMPT YOU PASTE

One clean page. Built in minutes.

When an owner gets curious enough to look you up, you want something there. Not a huge production. One clean page that says who you help and what you do. HighLevel has a website builder, Lovable, built right in. Paste the prompt below, swap in your details, and you've got a presence.

PASTE INTO LOVABLE • SWAP APPLIANCE REPAIR FOR YOUR NICHE

Build a clean, modern, one-page website for a marketing agency that helps appliance repair businesses get more Google reviews and stop missing calls.

The visitor is the owner of a local appliance repair company. Tone: trustworthy, approachable, local. Not corporate.

Sections in order:

1. Hero: a headline about helping appliance repair businesses get more 5-star reviews and win more jobs. A short subhead, and one button: "Get a Free Review Audit."
2. The problem: three short cards. "Not enough Google reviews," "Missed calls become missed jobs," "Competitors rank higher."
3. What you do: a simple done-for-you review system. Automatic review requests after every job, AI that responds to reviews, and the best reviews reposted to social. One line each.
4. Why it works: more recent reviews means higher Google ranking and more calls. Include a spot for one testimonial.
5. Pricing teaser: one plan, shown as "\$300/month."
6. Final call to action: a contact form (name, business name, email, phone) headed "Get Your Free Review Audit."

Style: blue and clean, mobile-first, big readable fonts, minimal stock photos. Every section points to one action: book the free audit. Use placeholders for agency name, logo, and phone so I can fill in my own.

KEEP IT LEAN

This is your storefront, not your masterpiece. One page that loads fast and makes the next step obvious beats a sprawling site you never finish. You can always add to it once you've got a client or two paying for it.

A note on what this site is for: it's where your prospect lands when they look you up, and where your "free review audit" offer lives. It is not the page you send to their customers. That's a separate review-service page. Keep the two straight: this one sells you; that one sells the service.

PHASE 09

Your first 30 days

A plan so you never have to wonder what to do next. It assumes a few focused hours a week, not a full-time grind. The point isn't speed. It's momentum.

FOLLOW IT IN ORDER

The fastest way to stall is no sequence.

So here's the sequence. Work it in order.

Days 1–2 **Set up. Get your house in order.**

Start your HighLevel trial, clone Agency OS, and build your agency site from the Phase 08 prompt. Pick your agency name. Don't overthink it. "Done" beats "perfect."

Days 3–5 **Find. Pick your towns and build a list.**

Work the city list. Run the Phase 02 gap test on five or six towns. Find ten shops in your niche sitting in the review tail. Audit each with the Phase 03 sheet.

Days 6–10 **Reach. Send your first ten messages.**

Use the Phase 04 opener, personalized with each shop's real gap. Add them to your follow-up sequence. Your first ten conversations will feel rough. That's normal. Everyone's are.

Days 11–20 **Follow up. Keep the conversations alive.**

Most replies come on message two or three, not one. Send your audits to anyone who bites. Keep adding new prospects so the top of your list never runs dry. Aim for ten new messages a week.

Days 21–30 **Close & deliver. Land one, run reactivation.**

When someone says yes, set up their Review Revenue System and run the reactivation campaign first. That's the fast visible win. Their first wave of reviews becomes the case study that gets you the next client.

A WORD ON THE TIMELINE

The first client usually takes longer than you want. The second comes faster, the third faster still. Simple is not the same as easy. The system is simple, but you still have to send the messages and show up. Nobody who built something real felt ready first. They sent the message anyway.

Reviews are the front door.

Once you've delivered and earned trust, the relationship expands on its own. An owner who's seen real results says yes to whatever you suggest next. Don't bundle-dump. Sell one, deliver, then offer the next rung.

1 **Review Revenue System • \$300/mo**

Your entry point. The fastest yes. The whole reason this playbook exists.

2 **AI Receptionist • +\$300/mo**

Answers the calls they miss while they're on the job. Books the work automatically. This is the second conversation you saved from Phase 03.

3 **Revenue Website • +\$500/mo**

A clean site that turns visitors into booked calls. The rung after they trust you completely.

SIMPLE SCALES. COMPLICATED STALLS.

The temptation is to lead with all three. Don't. The reason this works is that you start with one thing every owner already understands, deliver it, and let the trust you earned open the next door. One service, results, then expand. That's how you keep clients for years instead of overwhelming them and losing them in sixty days.

Six years.

I have a client, a roofer, who has paid me every month for six years. Same client. And it started with one simple thing I set up in an afternoon.

I want you to sit with that, because it points at something most people chasing their first client completely miss. They're focused on the getting. The pitch, the outreach, the yes. But the yes isn't where the money is.

The money is in what happens after the yes. Every month, for years, from work you mostly did once.

He didn't start at six years of services. He started the way everyone in this playbook starts: with one simple thing he already knew he needed. Reviews. Set up once, running in the background, quietly making him look like the most trusted roofer in town.

What kept him for six years wasn't the reviews alone. It was that once the first thing worked, the next yes got easier. Reviews became the front door, and over the years the relationship grew into more. But it all traces back to one afternoon and one simple service that proved I was worth keeping around.

That's the quiet power of this model. You're not hunting for a new client every month to replace the one that left. You're stacking clients who stay, on top of a service so simple it almost runs itself. Get one. Keep them. Then do it again.

PHASE 10

Setting it up in HighLevel

The click-path that turns the Review Revenue System from an idea into something running in your account. Most of it is already built when you clone Agency OS.

WHERE EACH PIECE LIVES

Knowing what to do, meet where to click.

You can deliver everything in this playbook by hand. But the reason it scales to ten or twenty clients without a team is that one platform, HighLevel, does the repetitive parts for you. This is the easy way: clone the pre-built setup, swap in the business name, and the whole Review Revenue System is running. If you start a free trial through the link at the back of this book, here's where each piece lives.

The blanks below are intentional. HighLevel's layout shifts over time, so you fill in those menu paths the first time and your copy stays accurate forever.

DONE FOR YOU

already built or the path is given, just do it

YOU FILL IN

a blank to complete the first time you set it up

ALREADY BUILT

1• Clone Agency OS into your account. When you start your trial through the link, Agency OS installs the review campaigns, follow-up workflows, and templates with one click. You start from the finished system, not a blank screen. Do this first.

YOU FILL IN

2• Find the review request workflow. The three-message sequence lives in your workflows. Set the trigger to fire when a job is marked complete, then swap in your client's business name and paste their Google review link. The logic is already built. You're only personalizing the words.

Menu path: _____ → _____ → the review request workflow

PATH CONFIRMED

3• Turn on automated review responses. Go to reputation settings, turn on AI review response, select Google, and hit save. Every new review now gets a reply within minutes. This is what signals to Google the business is engaged.

YOU FILL IN

4• Load the reactivation list. The fast first win. Import the client's past-customer list and drip review requests out slowly: two or three every twenty minutes during business hours. Never blast them all at once. Expect 8 to 15% to leave a review.

Import contacts at: _____ → _____

YOU FILL IN

5• Connect social for repurposing. Connect the client's Facebook, Instagram, and Google profile so five-star reviews automatically become social posts on a schedule you set.

Connect accounts at: _____ → _____

IF YOU GET STUCK ON ANY STEP

You get a private members community and live coaching when you sign up. That's the place to ask when a menu doesn't look the way you expected. And remember the manual fallback from Phase 06: every one of these can be done by hand.

PHASE 11

The niche & city lists

Thirty boring, unsexy niches to choose from, and two hundred towns to begin your search. Starting points, not guarantees. The map is always the real filter.

PICK ONE NICHE • RUN THE GAP TEST

Thirty boring goldmines.

Each one is local, phone-first, and review-driven, with an owner who's great at the work and absent online. Pick one. The "why it wins" tells you the opening; the pain point tells you what the owner already feels.

NICHE	WHY IT WINS	OWNER'S PAIN
Garage Door Repair	Pure Maps over ads	Out in the truck; misses calls
Tree Services & Arborists	High ticket, few agencies	Chainsaws running means missed quotes
Junk Removal	Huge map-pack reliance	Hard to stand out without reviews
Mobile Diesel Mechanics	Specialized, near-zero competition	B2B clients lose money if a truck is down
Commercial Grease Traps	Mandatory, recurring retention	Owners ignore marketing entirely
Septic Pumping & Repair	Extreme Maps over ads	Owner is the primary operator
Foundation & Crawlspace	High ticket (\$5k–\$15k+)	Trust gap; needs review reassurance
Water & Mold Remediation	Instant intent; insurance pays	Franchises bury the independents
Asphalt & Crack Sealing	Transactional, high-visibility	Seasonal; needs a fast pipeline
Luxury Garage Epoxy	High-ticket, rarely targeted	Hard to prove quality without a gallery
Gutter Guard & Cleaning	High-volume local traffic	Misses calls while working
Chimney Sweeps & Repair	Seasonal fall/winter intent	Relies on word-of-mouth
Commercial Office Cleaning	Steady recurring revenue	Invisible Google footprint
Dumpster Rental	Renovators need speed	Logistics eat the day
Locksmiths	Maps dominate 90% of calls	Spam listings; needs authority

NICHE	WHY IT WINS	OWNER'S PAIN
Restaurant Hood Cleaning	Fire-safety regulated	Managers don't have time to research
Water Well Drilling & Pumps	Regional, specialized	Lacks local search optimization
Document Shredding	Security, transactional	Analog, invisible online
Pallet Recycling & Supply	Hidden logistics niche	Analog; needs a map presence
Stump Grinding	Micro-niche, separate from tree	Needs density in a small area
Towing & Roadside	Maps reliance; pure urgency	Needs to be #1 at the breakdown moment
Emergency Plumbing & Snaking	Bypasses crowded general plumbing	24/7; can't answer every call
Window Screen Repair	Specific sub-niche	Near-zero agency competition
Forklift Repair & Rental	Niche equipment need	Warehouse managers need reliability
Radon Mitigation	Safety-critical, regional	Specialized; trust is everything
Pet Cremation	High-emotion, high-trust	Needs a compassionate local presence
Specialty Auto Repair	Specific car types/brands	Hard to stand out from generic shops
Boat & Marine Repair	Specialized, high-intent	Owners research local experts deeply
Appliance Repair	High-frequency need	Needs map-pack dominance
Home Inspectors	Essential transaction step	Needs realtor referrals + Maps

EXECUTION STRATEGY

Pick one. Don't mix and match. Depth beats breadth every time.

Run the 20-mile rule. Use Google Maps to find fifty prospects within range of a town that passes the gap test.

Check the review gap. Target businesses with under fifty reviews and no owner replies. That's the visible, easy-to-close opening.

Two hundred towns to begin.

Run the Phase 02 test on each before you reach out. A city earns its place here by size, but it earns your time by the review gap you find on the map. Populations are rough estimates. Trust the search results over any number on this page.

ALABAMA • AL

Alabaster, Auburn, Decatur, Dothan, Florence, Gadsden, Madison, Opelika, Phenix City, Prattville

ARIZONA • AZ

Bullhead City, Casa Grande, Flagstaff, Kingman, Lake Havasu City, Maricopa, Prescott, Prescott Valley, Sierra Vista, Yuma

ARKANSAS • AR

Benton, Bentonville, Conway, Fayetteville, Fort Smith, Hot Springs, Jonesboro, Pine Bluff, Rogers, Russellville

GEORGIA • GA

Albany, Dalton, Gainesville, Hinesville, LaGrange, Newnan, Rome, Statesboro, Valdosta, Warner Robins

IDAHO • ID

Caldwell, Coeur d'Alene, Eagle, Idaho Falls, Kuna, Lewiston, Pocatello, Post Falls, Rexburg, Twin Falls

ILLINOIS • IL

Bloomington, Champaign, Danville, Decatur, DeKalb, Galesburg, Moline, Normal, Pekin, Quincy

INDIANA • IN

Bloomington, Columbus, Elkhart, Kokomo, Lafayette, Muncie, New Albany, Richmond, Terre Haute, West Lafayette

IOWA • IA

Ames, Ankeny, Cedar Falls, Council Bluffs, Dubuque, Iowa City, Marion, Sioux City, Urbandale, Waterloo

MICHIGAN • MI

Battle Creek, Bay City, East Lansing, Holland, Jackson, Kentwood, Midland, Muskegon, Portage, Saginaw

MISSOURI • MO

Ballwin, Blue Springs, Cape Girardeau, Chesterfield, Florissant, Jefferson City, Joplin, Liberty, St. Joseph, Wentzville

NORTH CAROLINA • NC

Asheville, Burlington, Goldsboro, Greenville, Hickory, Jacksonville, Kannapolis, New Bern, Rocky Mount, Wilson

OHIO • OH

Beavercreek, Bowling Green, Canton, Elyria, Findlay, Hamilton, Kettering, Lima, Mansfield, Middletown

OKLAHOMA • OK

Bartlesville, Edmond, Enid, Lawton, Midwest City, Moore, Muskogee, Owasso, Shawnee, Stillwater

OREGON • OR

Albany, Corvallis, Grants Pass, Keizer, Lake Oswego, McMinnville, Medford, Oregon City, Redmond, Springfield

SOUTH CAROLINA • SC

Aiken, Florence, Goose Creek, Greenville, Hilton Head Island, Mount Pleasant, Myrtle Beach, Rock Hill, Spartanburg, Sumter

TENNESSEE • TN

Cleveland, Columbia, Cookeville, Franklin, Gallatin, Hendersonville, Jackson, Johnson City, Kingsport, Lebanon

TEXAS • TX

Conroe, Del Rio, Galveston, Longview, Mission, New Braunfels, Pharr, San Angelo, Temple, Texarkana

WASHINGTON • WA

Bellingham, Bremerton, Kennewick, Lacey, Longview, Olympia, Pasco, Pullman, Richland, Yakima

WISCONSIN • WI

Appleton, Beloit, Eau Claire, Fond du Lac, Janesville, La Crosse, Oshkosh, Racine, Sheboygan, Wausau

You can build all of this by hand.

Nothing in this playbook requires special software. You can track customers in a spreadsheet, send the review texts yourself, write the responses by hand, and post the best ones to social manually. People did it that way for years. It works.

It's just slow. And slow is the enemy when you're trying to land your first client and deliver a result fast enough to keep them.

The whole reason a one-person agency can run twenty clients without a team is that the repetitive work is automated.

That's what HighLevel does. It's the platform every message, every workflow, and every automation in this playbook was built for. The review requests fire on their own. The follow-ups send themselves. The reactivation campaign drips out without you babysitting it. You set it up once and it runs.

And you don't have to build any of it. It's already built, ready to clone into your account in a single click.

EVERYTHING YOU GET WITH THE FREE TRIAL

The whole thing, done for you.

Start a free 30-day HighLevel trial through the link below and the entire system, plus everything you need to run it, unlocks in your account. This is the same Agency OS setup behind real one-person agencies.

- **The Agency OS Snapshot**
The complete Review Revenue System, pre-built. Review campaigns, follow-up workflows, and automations clone in with one click. You customize the words, not the wiring.
- **Word-for-Word Scripts**
The outreach messages, the follow-ups, and the responses from this playbook, ready to use inside the platform.
- **The 90-Day Roadmap**
A step-by-step plan that picks up where this playbook ends and takes you from setup to paying clients.
- **The Private Community**
A members community with live builder sessions, so when you get stuck, there's a room full of people who've already sorted it out.
- **A Kickoff Call**
A guided setup session to get your account and your first system running, so day one doesn't get lost to figuring out where to click.

Start your free 30-day trial & unlock the system

adamerhart.co/4aQzZyh

Most people get fourteen days. This link gets you thirty, plus everything above.
There's more on the full page once you're there.

THE WHOLE GAME

The only thing left is sending the message.

You now have the niche, the town, the audit, the words, and the offer. You have the whole system, and the easy way to run it. Everything up to the line is done.

In ten years of doing this, nobody who built something real felt ready before their first client. They sent an imperfect message anyway, and learned the rest by doing.

**Pick a town from the list. Audit three shops.
Send three messages today.**

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